

PRESIDENT

Also known as Scum, Asshole, or Capitalism. A multi-round climbing card game where finishing position in each round determines your role (and advantages) in the next.

SETUP

- ♦ 4 to 8 players
- ♦ Standard 52-card deck (no jokers), dealt evenly (discard remainders or give to President)
- ♦ First round: player with 3 of clubs leads. Subsequent rounds: Scum leads

ROLES (FROM PREVIOUS ROUND)

POSITION	ROLE	ADVANTAGE
1st out	President	Receives 2 best cards from Scum
2nd out	Vice President	Receives 1 best card from Vice Scum
2nd last	Vice Scum	Gives 1 best card to Vice President
Last out	Scum	Gives 2 best cards to President

Middle positions (in 5+ player games) have no trading obligation.

RULES

- 1 Lead player plays any valid combination (single, pair, triple, or sequence)
- 2 Each subsequent player must play the same combination type but higher value, or pass
- 3 When all players pass consecutively, the last player who played leads the next trick
- 4 First player to empty their hand finishes 1st, second finishes 2nd, etc.
- 5 Round ends when all but one player has emptied their hand — that player is Scum
- 6 Roles are assigned based on finishing order
- 7 Card trading occurs before the next round begins
- 8 Game continues for a set number of rounds or until a player accumulates enough “President” wins

CARD RANKING

2 > A > K > Q > J > 10 > 9 > 8 > 7 > 6 > 5 > 4 > 3

(Same as Big 2 — 2 is highest)

KEY DIFFERENCES FROM BIG 2

CONCEPT	BIG 2	PRESIDENT
Players	4 (fixed)	4–8 (variable)
Rounds	Single	Multi-round with persistent roles
Card trading	None	Forced exchange based on roles
Who leads	3 of diamonds	Scum (lowest rank)
Win condition	First to empty hand	Accumulate President wins
Deck	Standard 52	Standard 52 (split evenly)
Combinations	Singles, pairs, 5-card hands	Singles, pairs, triples, sequences

WHY THIS TESTS THE ENGINE

President forces the engine to handle:

- ♦ **Multi-round persistence** — roles and scores carry between rounds
- ♦ **Asymmetric card dealing** — trading phase modifies hands before play
- ♦ **Variable player count** — same rules scale from 4 to 8
- ♦ **Role-based turn order** — who leads depends on previous round outcome
- ♦ **State between rounds** — not just within a single game
- ♦ **Component interaction** — deck (deal) + player state (roles) + game flow (rounds)